

Airbnb Cape Town Business Analysis.

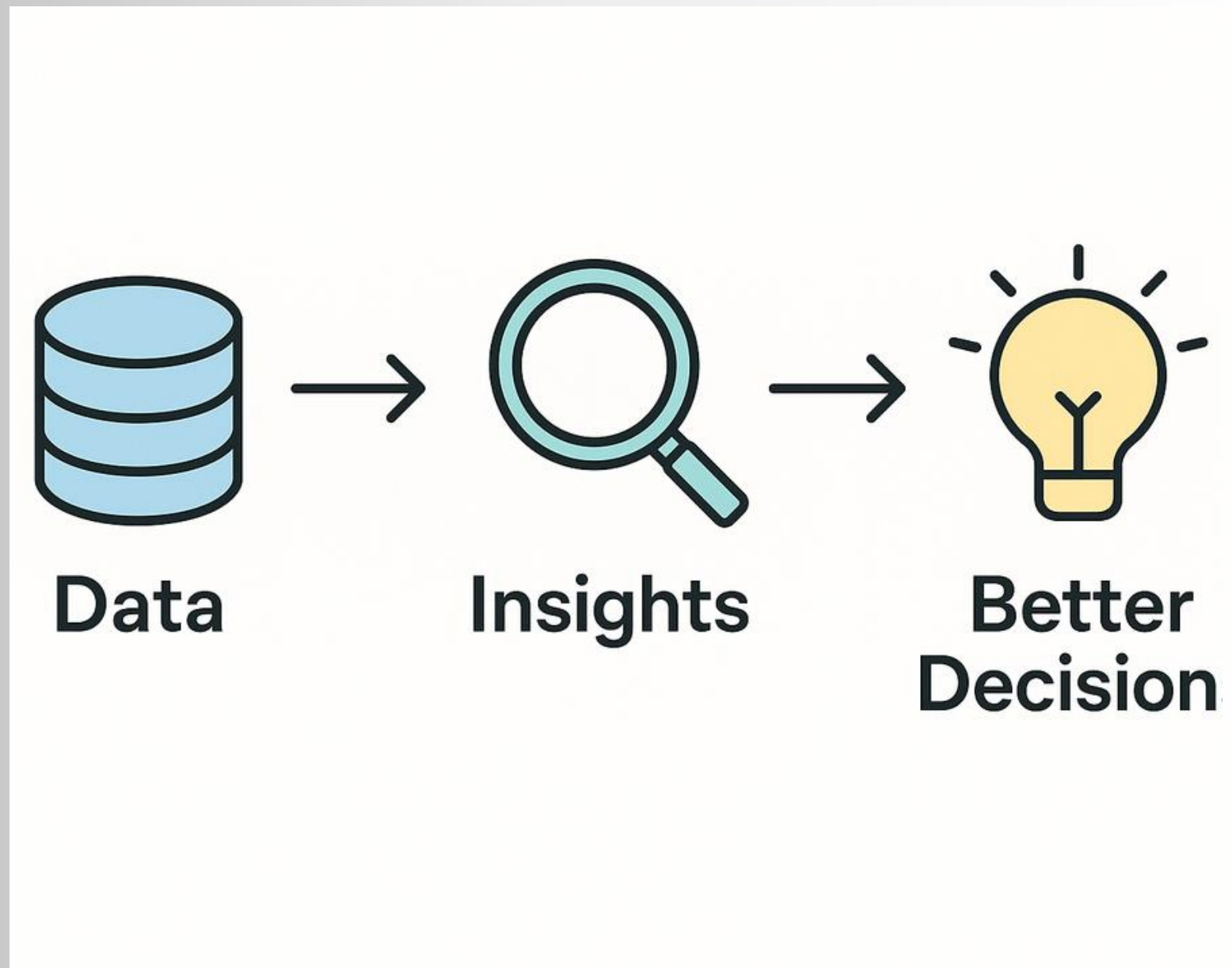
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A data-driven guide for Airbnb hosts

OVERVIEW

- Cape Town's Airbnb market is competitive and fast-growing.
- Many hosts—especially new ones—struggle to set prices and estimate revenue.
- We built a data-driven tool to help hosts:
 - Predict expected revenue.
 - Suggest improvements to increase earnings.



BUSINESS UNDERSTANDING

The Problem:

- Hosts risk losing bookings or undervaluing their property without good pricing and availability strategies.

Our Solution:

- A Revenue Recommender System that learns from past Airbnb data and gives clear, actionable tips.

Goal:

- Identify drivers of revenue

Predict expected revenue based on price, availability, location, and reviews.”



Revenue



Data Understanding

Data Sources

We used Airbnb's public Cape Town datasets:



Listings.csv – Property details (location, room type, amenities)



Calendar.csv – Daily prices and availability



Reviews.csv – Guest ratings and comments



Neighbourhoods.csv – Mapping of areas in Cape Town

Data Preparation



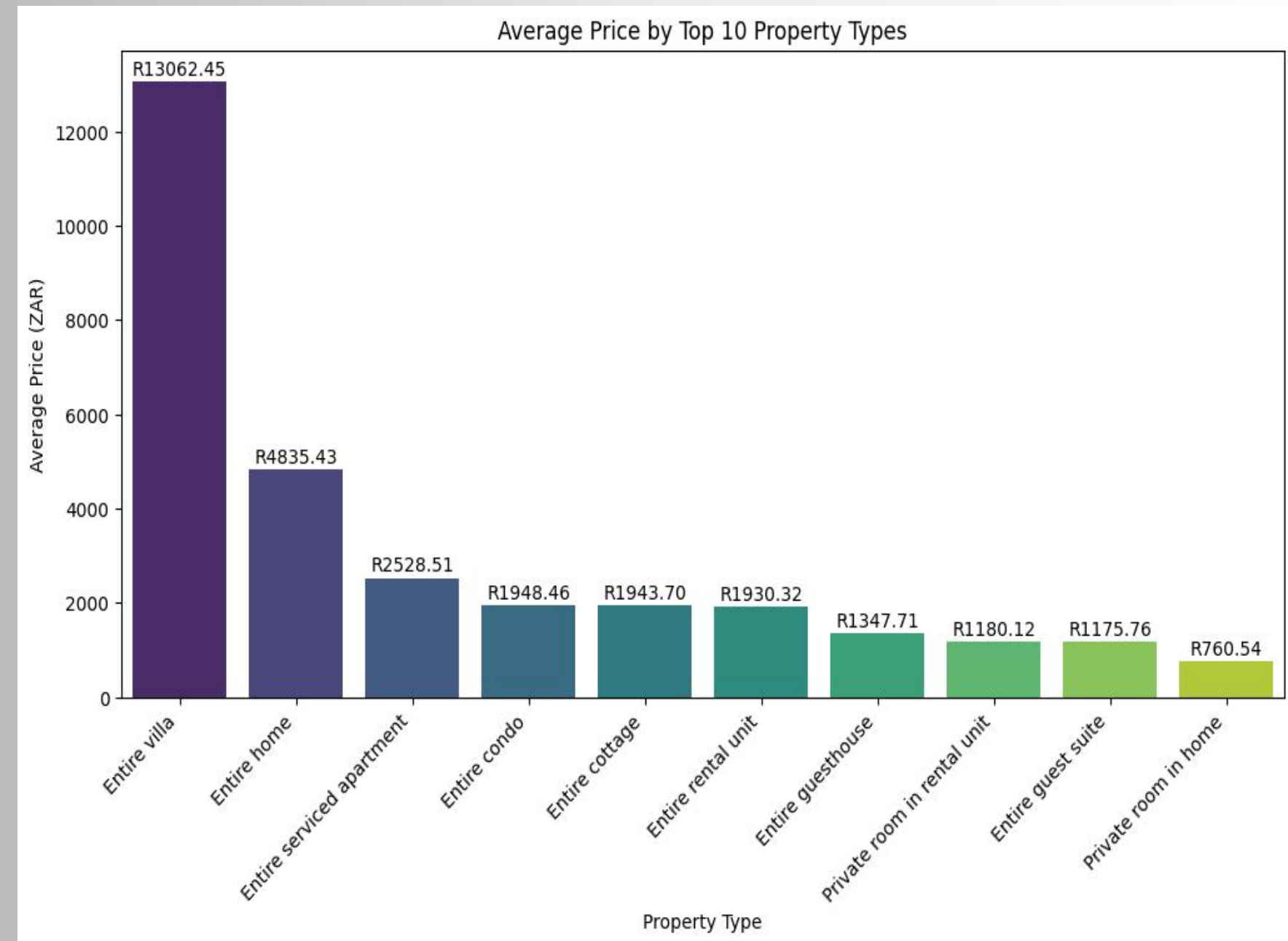
To make sure our analysis was accurate, we:

- Removed outliers
- Filled missing values in reviews and availability.
- Converted categories to numbers so models can understand them.
- Created new features like seasonal availability trends.

Key Data Insights

property type has a huge impact on earnings.

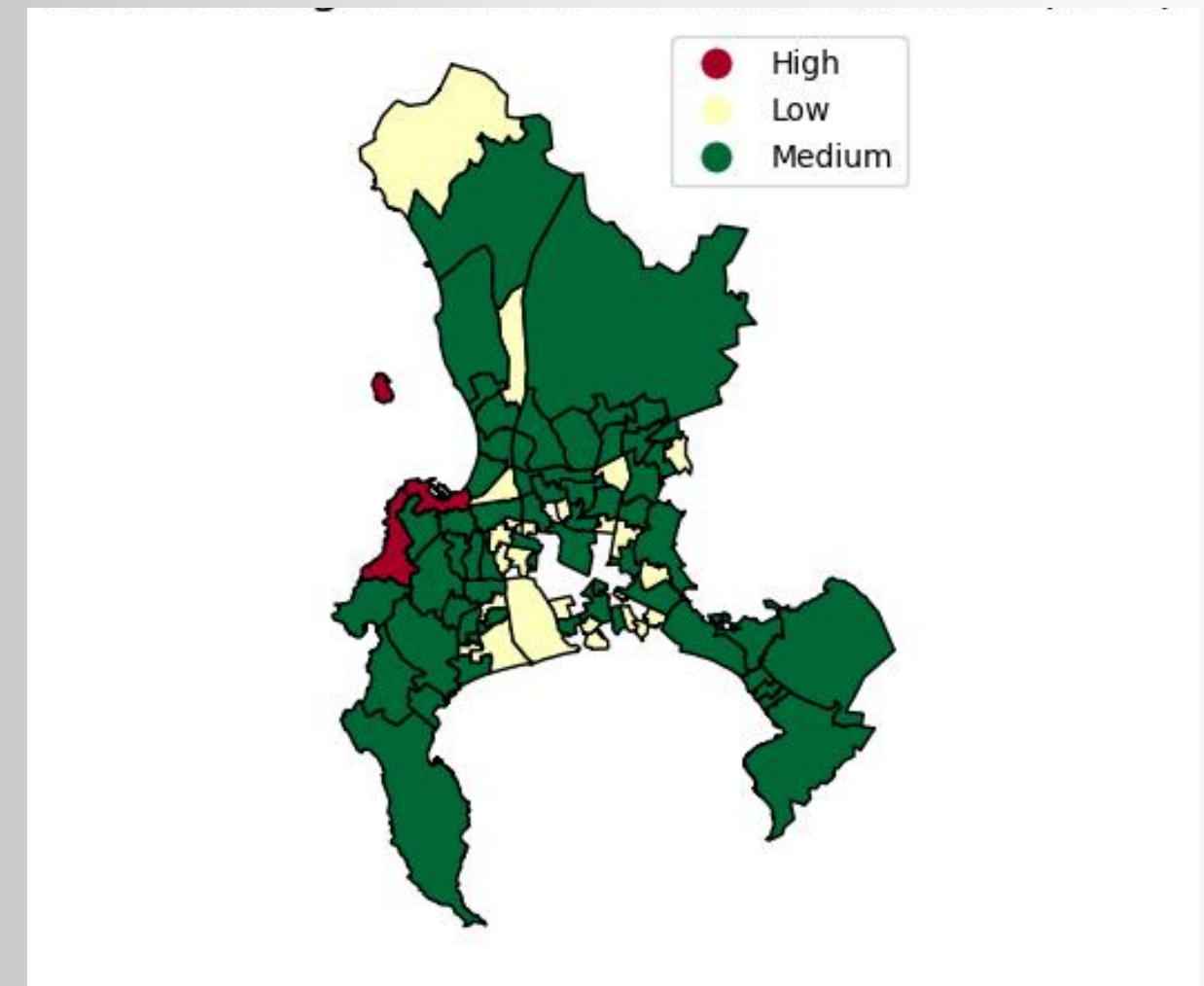
- Luxury properties earn far more: Villas charge the highest average price
- Entire homes are much more profitable (~R4,800) compared to smaller units.
- Serviced apartments and condos are mid-range options (~R2,000–R2,500).
- Private rooms earn the least (under R1,200 on average).



GEOGRAPHIC INSIGHTS

Airbnb Neighborhood Demand

- High-demand zones (Red): concentrated in central/west areas with strong tourism pull.
- Medium-demand zones (Green): cover most neighborhoods, showing steady but moderate bookings.
- Low-demand zones (Yellow): scattered pockets, often peripheral or less connected.



Modelling

We tried several “smart tools” to see which predicts revenue best:

- Linear Regression – Looks for straight-line relationships between factors like price, location, and revenue.
- Random Forest – Handles complex situations where many factors work together.
- Gradient Boosting – Combines many small models to make very accurate predictions.
- Clustering – Groups similar listings together so we can compare performance within each group.



Findings

- Price, location, and room type are the biggest drivers of revenue
- Higher review scores boost revenue potential
- Availability patterns (especially during peak season) matter a lot





Recommendations

To boost revenue, hosts should:

- Offer entire homes if possible
- Increase booking availability
- Maintain high review scores
- Optimize pricing using our model's feedback



Next Steps

We plan to:

- ✓ Launch a prototype dashboard using Streamlit
- ✓ Allow host input + instant feedback
- ✓ Deploy model as an API for future apps
- ✓ Share with local host communities



Limitations

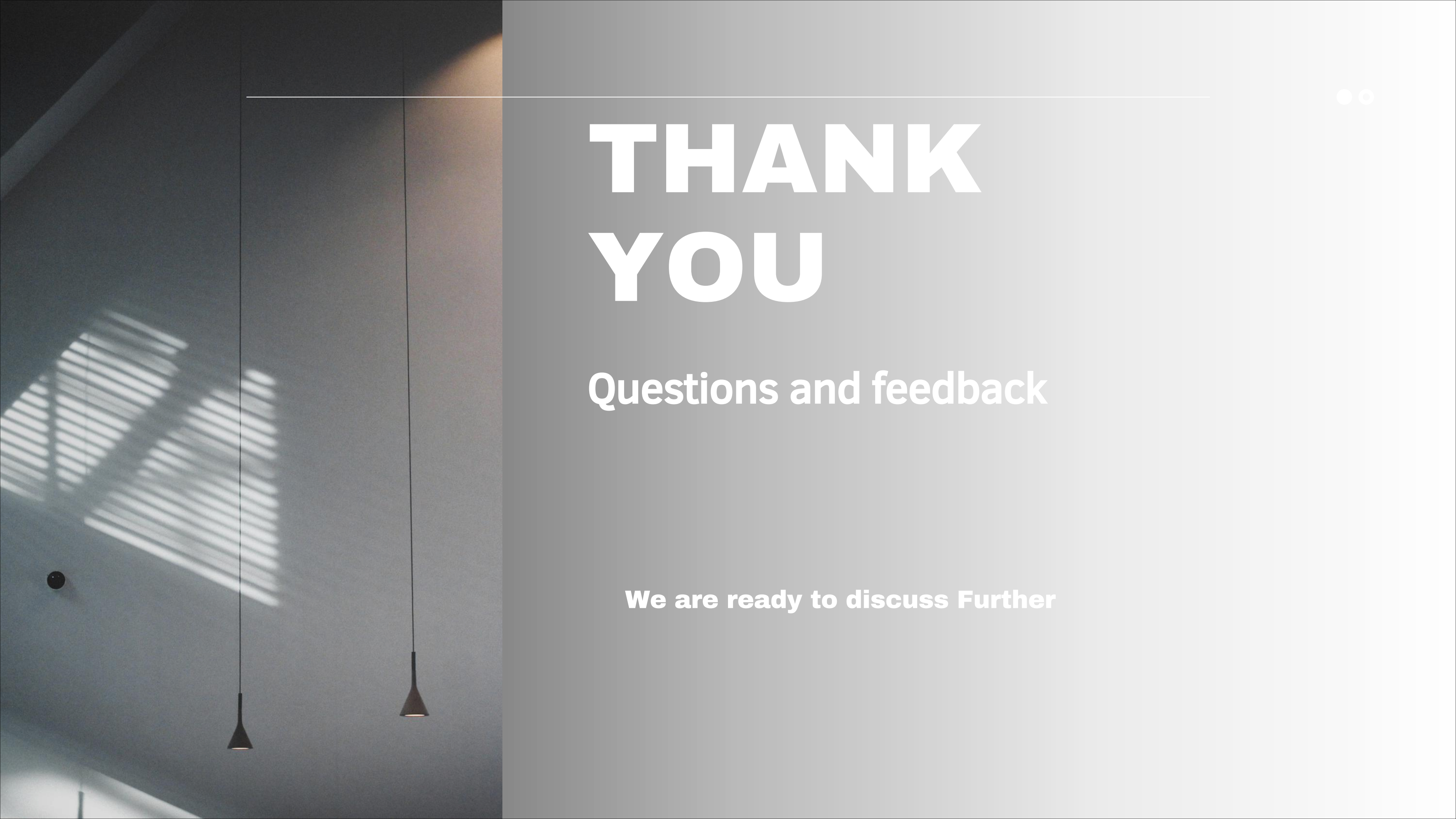
- Data may not reflect recent Airbnb trends
- Sparse reviews or availability can reduce accuracy
- External market shocks are not captured in this dataset.



Conclusion

- To wrap up ,our tool empowers hosts with clear, data-backed insights to improve earnings and stay competitive. We'd be happy to dive deeper into any part of the analysis.





THANK YOU

Questions and feedback

We are ready to discuss Further